

LakeTemperature Testing Software

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Background

- We are testing a module of *E3SM*,¹ an environmental model. This module, *LakeTemperature*, is part of the greater *ELM* (*E3SM* Land Model) which was originally a fork of the *CLM* (Community Land Model).
- We are able to test specifically this module using *SPEL*,² a software that adds a *NetCDF*³ interface for the constants, inputs, and outputs of a module of *E3SM* and compiles that specific part of the model. The executable produced by this is named `elmtest.exe`.

1. "Energy Exascale Earth System Model." E3SM, U.S. Department of Energy: Office of Science, n.d., e3sm.org/.

2. Schwartz, Peter. "SPEL_OpenACC." GitHub, 16 Oct. 2025, github.com/peterdschwartz/SPEL_OpenACC.git.

3. "NetCDF." NSF UNIDATA, n.d., www.unidata.ucar.edu/software/netcdf.

Project Goals

- Develop a software that can systematically change the constants used in the LakeTemperature model and allow us to visualize and observe patterns in how this affects its output.
- Apply testing techniques to try and find values for constants that will cause physically impossible or otherwise erroneous outputs. Apply assertions pertaining to the values of constants, inputs, and outputs based around physical laws and other constraints provided by domain scientists.

Our Testing Solution

- Automates the process of modifying constants in spel-constants0001.nc and the process of analyzing the resulting values in fut-outputs0001.nc
- Both the process of choosing values for each constant and the process of analyzing the resulting outputs is extendable through sampling plugins and analysis plugins respectively.

Sampling Plugins

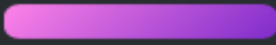
SampleGroup(s)

Testing

Tables of Testing Data

Analysis Plugins

Key

-  = Input Data
-  = Reference Data
-  = Output Data



Testing Expanded



Sample Generation



Using a Sampling Plugin to create samples with unique values for the 25 scalar constants.



Running elmtest.exe



Running the program using the constants and recording the results.



Analysis



Using an Analysis Plugin to analyze the results, especially in comparison to reference data.

Constants, Inputs, and Outputs

- The 28 constants control how the model behaves and manipulates data.
 - We don't yet support modification of the 3 array constants. Of the other 25 scalar constants we do experiment with, 8 have no observable effect on the output.
- The 26 inputs provide starting data for the model.
- The 9 outputs include data that the model has generated.
- 8 variables are both an input and an output in some instances.

Constants, Inputs, and Outputs

Array Constants	
Scalar Constants (with observable effects)	betavis
	cnfac
	cpliq
	denh20
	dtime_mod
	grav
	hfus
	lake_no_ed
	lakepuddling

Constants, Inputs, and Outputs

Scalar Constants (with observable effects)	nlevgrnd
	nlevlak
	nlevsno
	nlevsoi
	thk_bedrock
	tkwat
	use_lch4
	vk
Scalar Constants (without observable effects)	cpice
	denice
	depthcrit
	iulog

Constants, Inputs, and Outputs

Scalar Constants (without observable effects)	mixfact
	pudz
	tkair
	tkice
Inputs	betaprime_col
	eflx_gnet
	eflx_sh_grnd
	eflx_sh_tot
	eflx_snomelt
	eflx_soil_grnd
	errsoi
	grnd_ch4_cond_col

Constants, Inputs, and Outputs

Inputs

hc_soi

hc_soisno

imelt

lakeresist_col

lake_icefrac_col

lake_icethick_col

qflx_snofrz_lyr

qflx_snomelt

qflx_snow_melt

savedtke1_col

sh2osno

snow_depth

Constants, Inputs, and Outputs

Inputs	t_lake
	t_soisno
Inputs & Outputs	

Constants, Inputs, and Outputs

Inputs & Outputs	
Outputs	ch4_vars
	col_ef
	col_es
	col_wf
	col_ws
	lakestate_vars
	veg_ef

NetCDF

- Network Common Data Form (*NetCDF*) is a format for self-describing datasets. Each file is composed of “dimensions” and “variables.” Variables are multi-dimensional arrays, with the meaning of each dimension described in the file.

```
netcdf x_times_y {  
  dimensions:  
    x = 5 ;  
    y = 5 ;  
  variables:  
    float x(x) ;  
    float y(y) ;  
    float z(x, y) ;  
  data:  
  
    x = -2, -1, 0, 1, 2 ;  
  
    y = -4, -2, 0, 2, 4 ;  
  
    z =  
      8, 4, -0, -4, -8,  
      4, 2, -0, -2, -4,  
      -0, -0, 0, 0, 0,  
      -4, -2, 0, 2, 4,  
      -8, -4, 0, 4, 8 ;  
}
```

What is a Sample?

- A sample is a set of values for the constants contained in `spel-constants0001.nc`.
 - ~~There are 28 constants in total. We don't yet support modification of the 3 array constants. Of the 25 scalar constants we experiment with, 8 have no observable effect on the output.~~
- `elmtest.exe` is run once for each sample.

What is a Sample? (Illustration)

Constants (formerly lakeparams.txt)

```
betavis
0.0
za_lake
0.6
n2min
7.4999999999999993E-005
tdmax
277.0
pudz
0.0
mixfact
10.0
depthcrit
25.0
```

Example Sample (JSON used for illustration)

```
{
  "betavis": 0.0,
  "za_lake": 0.6,
  "n2min": 7.4999999999999993E-005,
  "tdmax": 277.0,
  "pudz": 0.0,
  "mixfact": 10.0,
  "depthcrit": 25.0
}
```


What Outputs are Received per Sample?

- Analysis plugins will receive the outputs from the `spe1-outputs0001.nc` file in the form of multidimensional numpy arrays, which range from one to three dimensions.

Outputs Received by Analysis Plugins (JSON for illustration)

```
{  
  "veg_ef%eflx_soil_grnd": [0.0, ...],  
  "veg_ef%eflx_gnet": [[0.0, ...], ...],  
  ...  
}
```

Sample Groups

- Represents a grouping of samples, ordered—for the sake of simplicity, not necessity—to match indices with the list of model data
- Analysis plugins can analyze the result of multiple consecutive runs of `elmtest.exe` in context this way.
- Having multiple sample groups is useful because each one can cover a range of values for a specific combination of constants whose combined effect is being examined.

Sample Group Illustration

Sample Group Data (JSON for illustration)

```
[
  {
    "betavis": 0.0,
    ...
  },
  {
    "betavis": 0.25,
    ...
  },
  {
    "betavis": 0.5,
    ...
  }
]
```

Ordered Output Data (JSON for illustration)

```
[
  {
    "lakestate_vars%betaprime_col": [0.0, ...],
    ...
  },
  {
    "lakestate_vars%betaprime_col": [0.25, ...],
    ...
  },
  {
    "lakestate_vars%betaprime_col": [0.5, ...],
    ...
  }
]
```

Plugins

- Our testing framework supports two types of plugins, sampling and analysis. Sampling plugins define values for constants, and analysis plugins view the outputs of the model.

Sampling Plugin Interface

- Sampling plugins define a subclass of `Sampler`, returning one or more `SampleGroups`, which are sequences of individual samples.

Analysis Plugin Interface

- Analysis plugins can either be “per sample” or “sample group” analysis plugins.
- “Per sample” plugins define a subclass of `PerSampleAnalyzer`, whose methods are called each time `elmtest.exe` is run, and which receives the outputs produced by that specific sample.
- “Sample group” plugins define a subclass of `SampleGroupAnalyzer`, whose method is called after all samples in a group are run through `elmtest.exe`, and which receives all outputs from each.

Configuration

